KP being worst hit by bomb blasts, meant most of the provincial ministers in the KP (NWFP) deserted their offices at the Civil Secretariat following the string of bomb blasts in the city in 2009. They restricted themselves to their houses or did official work from the MPAs Hostel in Peshawar. Provincial Minister for Prisons Mian Nisar Gul Kakakhel shifted his office from the ministerial block to the fortified building near the Home Department, where Minister for Higher Education Qazi Muhammad Asad and Minister for Schools and Literacy Sardar Hussain Babak had their offices. These precautions further widened the gulf between the ministers and the people of their areas. Provincial ministers Rahim-dad Khan, Wajid Ali Khan, Ayub Khan Ashari, Sher Azam Wazir, Muhammad Humayun Khan, Arshad Abdullah and Mian Iftikhar Hussain shifted their offices in the same premises, where common people could not enter (*The News International*, 2009).

The socio-economic upheaval in the insurgency-hit area of Waziristan was evident from the harsh fact that a number of people from these areas migrated to settled areas of KP, where many remained jobless and started begging in the streets, mostly belonging to the Mehsud tribe.[4]

Insecurity and fear spread throughout Pakistan. It compelled the citizens, especially in cities, to adopt security measures in and around their residences. Gated housing colonies grew rapidly as people preferred to reside in a secure environment.[5] The trend of gated communities emerged after 2002, and the demand for housing there went up by an estimated 30 per cent from 2010 to 2012 due to an increasing need for secure housing communities.[6] Private security business also boomed. Registration of private security agencies increased manifold. It created an industry, with total worth of about $60 million a year.

Similarly, the residents of cities suffered from the effects of terrorism and psychological war. The terrorist threats to educational institutions, especially to co-ed private schools in Islamabad, Karachi and Lahore and a suicide attack on International Islamic University, Islamabad, resulting in the deaths of five female students added to the deep sense of insecurity among the teachers, students and parents (*Dawn*, 2009).

Simultaneously, the like-minded religious bigots took advantage to harass women on the streets by telling them to observe the so-called Islamic dress code. This trend was observed in Lahore. However, it petered out as soon as the government reacted and showed some will to handle the terrorists sternly.